Municipality of Oas, Albay Building Permit and Certificate of Occupancy System (BPCOS)

User Manual

Prepared by iConcept IT Solutions

SECTION 1

Getting Started with BPCOS

This section introduces the Building Permit and Certificate of Occupancy System (BPCOS), summarizes how a building permit moves through the system, and shows how to open BPCOS, sign in and create an account.

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1.1 About BPCOS

BPCOS is an online application of the OAS Unified Online Services of the Municipality of Oas, Albay. It is for builders and developers who apply for a building permit. It brings the whole process online: the application, the review of the requirements, the assessment of fees, the approval, the payment and the printing of the building permit, in line with the National Building Code. The applicant can send the request and follow its status at any time, and each office of the Municipality works on it in its own pages.

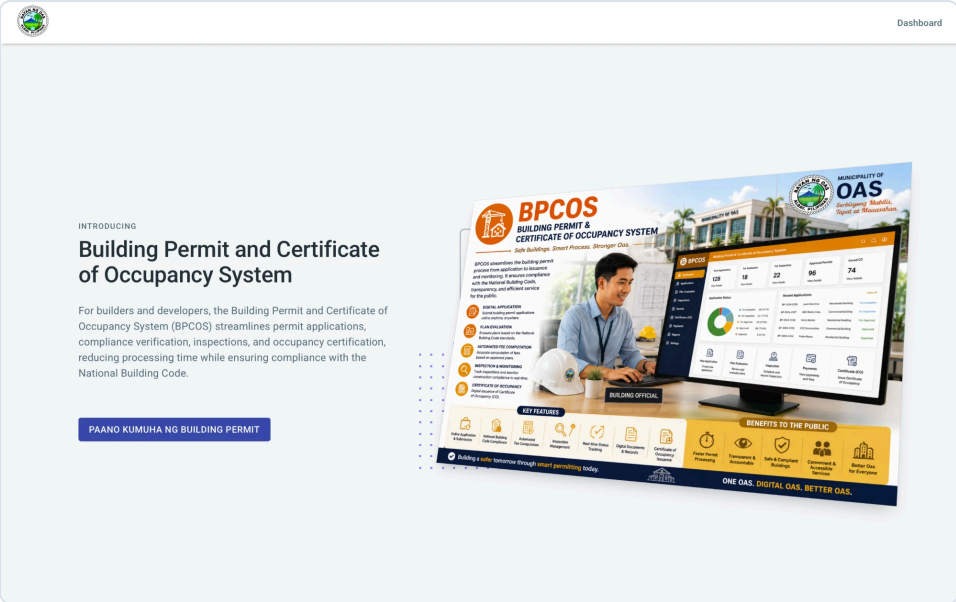


Figure 1.1. The BPCOS landing page.

1.2 Summary of the manual

A building permit goes from the applicant to four offices, in this order. The table shows who does what and where it is explained.

Step	Who	What happens	Section
1	**Applicant**	Creates an account and signs in, fills in the building permit request in four steps, uploads the requirements and sends them. The status of the application becomes **SENT TO OBO**.	Section 2
2	**Reviewer**	Opens the application, checks the form and the requirements, and sets the review as started.	Section 3
3	**Building Official**	Reviews each requirement (approve or decline), prepares the assessment of the fees, then approves or declines the permit. The status becomes **APPROVED**.	Section 4
4	**Treasury (cashier)**	Receives the payment of the assessed fees and issues the official receipt (OR). The status becomes **APPLICATION PAID**.	Section 5
5	**Moderator**	Adds the Fire Safety Evaluation Clearance (FSEC), uploads its certificate and prints the building permit.	Section 6

After the Moderator prints the building permit, the permit is released and the workflow ends. The applicant can then view the permit and print a copy, see Section 2.5.8.

- **Declined.** The Building Official can decline a requirement or the whole permit. A declined requirement shows **Status: Declined**, and a declined permit goes to **Declined Permits**.
- **Rollback.** The Moderator can send an approved permit back to the Building Official. The review and the approval must then be done again, see Section 4.5.3.
- **An assessment is required.** The Building Official cannot approve a permit without an assessment.

1.3 Opening BPCOS

1. Open a web browser and go to bpcos.oas.lguapp.com. You can also start from the OAS home page (oas.lguapp.com): scroll to **LGU Online Applications** and click the **Building Permit & Certificate of Occupancy** card.
2. The landing page opens. It names the system, **Building Permit and Certificate of Occupancy System**, and explains what it is for. The button **Paano Kumuha ng Building Permit** (How to get a building permit) is below the text.
3. Click **Dashboard** at the top right to go to the sign in page.

The first time you open the page, a notice about cookies appears at the bottom. Click **I Agree** to close it. A small message, *Settings Updated*, may appear at the top right. Click **Close** to close it.

1.4 Signing in

1. On the **Sign in** page, enter your **Email Address**.
2. Enter your **Password**.
3. Click **Log In**.

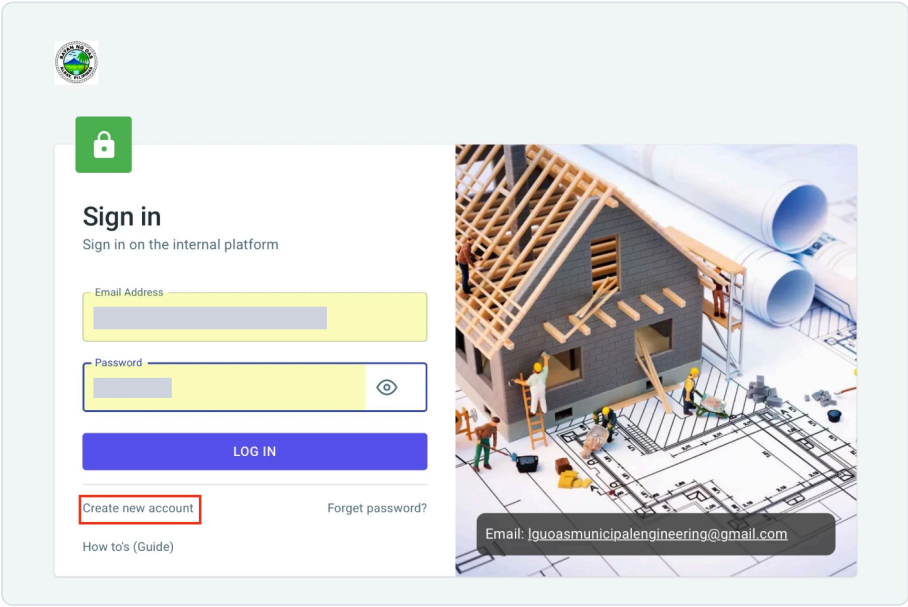


Figure 1.2. The Sign in page.

> **ERROR:** if a field is left empty, the system shows a red message under it (for example, *Email is required*). Fill in the field and try again.

If the email or password is wrong, a red message appears below the **Log In** button. The message depends on which entry is wrong.

1.4.1 If the password is wrong

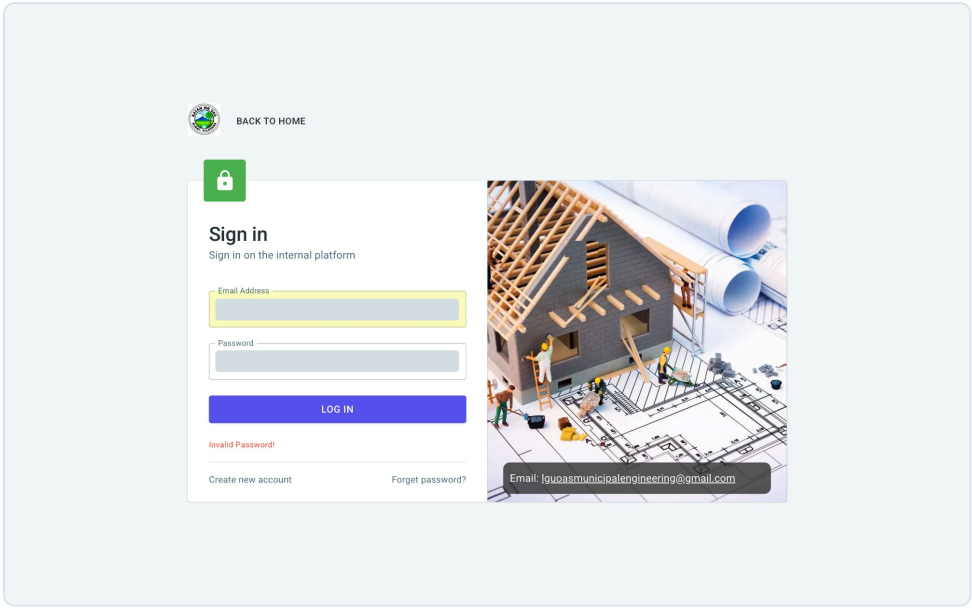


Figure 1.3. The Sign in page when the email is correct but the password is wrong.

1.4.2 If the email is not registered

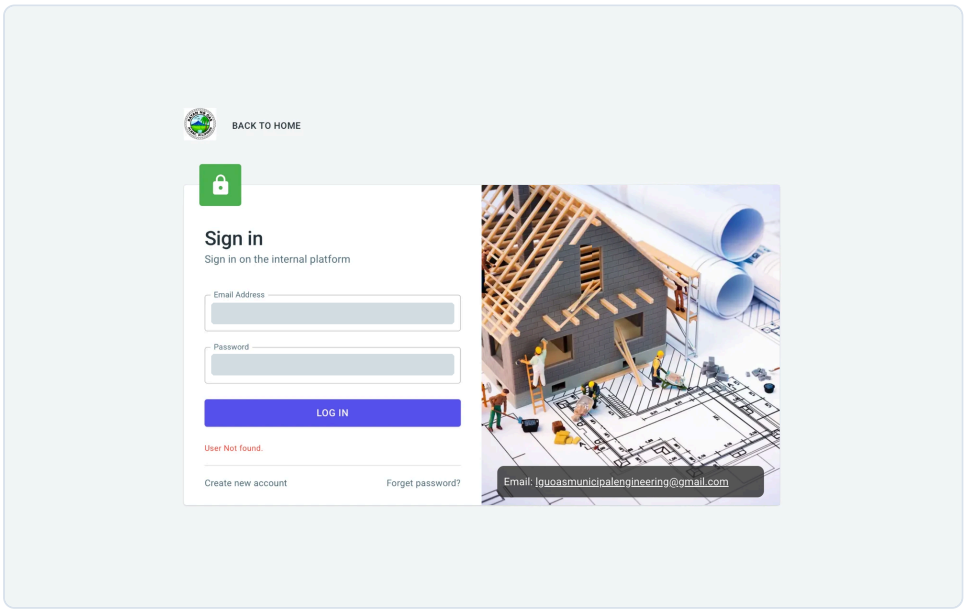


Figure 1.4. The Sign in page when no account exists for the email.

Summary of the messages:

Message	What it means
User Not found.	No account exists for the email you typed. Check the spelling or create an account.
Invalid Password!	The password does not match the account. Retype it, or use **Forget password?**

Other options on the Sign in page:

Option	Use it to
Create new account	Register as a new user (see Section 1.5).
Forget password?	Reset a forgotten password (see Section 1.7).
How to's (Guide)	Open the guides of the system.

1.5 Creating an account

New users must create an account before applying. From the Sign in page, click **Create new account** to open the **Sign up** form.

Screenshot of the Sign up form of BPCOS, with First Name, Last Name, Email Address, Password, Confirm Password, the Terms and Conditions box and Create account.

1. Enter your **First Name** and **Last Name**.
2. Enter a valid **Email Address**. A verification code will be sent to this address, so use an email you can open right now.
3. Enter a **Password** of at least 7 characters. Click the eye icon to show or hide it.
4. Type the same password again in **Confirm Password**. The label on the screen reads *Confim Password*.
5. Tick **I have read the Terms and Conditions**. The box must be ticked to continue.
6. Click **Create account**.

> All fields are required. After you click **Create account**, a verification code is sent to your email. Continue with the verification steps in Section 1.6.

1.5.1 If the email is already registered

If an account already exists for the email you entered, a red message appears at the lower left when you click **Create account**, and no code is sent.

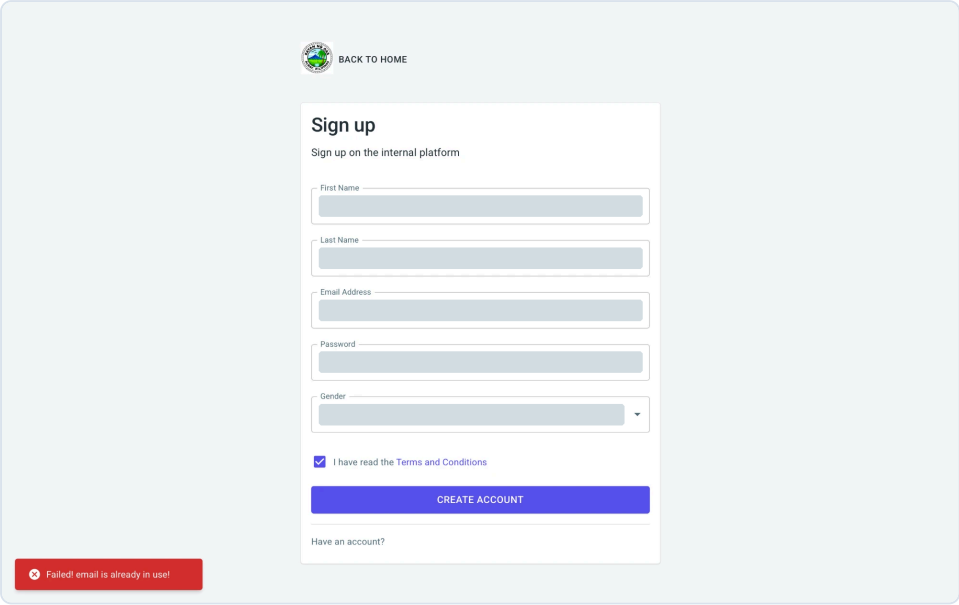


Figure 1.5. The message shown when the email is already in use.

> **ERROR:** *Failed! email is already in use!* Use a different email address, or go to the Sign in page and sign in with the existing account. If you forgot the password, use **Forget password?**

Already registered? Click **Have an account?** at the bottom of the form to go back to the Sign in page.

1.6 Verifying your email

After you click **Create account**, the form is replaced by a verification screen and a green message appears at the lower left: *Check your email and copy the code!*

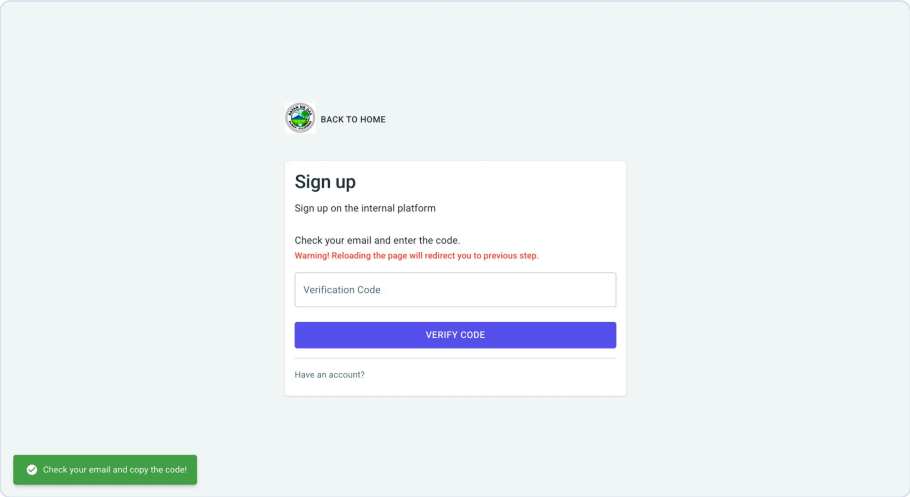


Figure 1.6. The verification screen after clicking Create account.

> **WARNING:** do not reload or refresh this page. Reloading sends you back to the previous step (the Sign up form) and you will need to start again.

1. Open the email address you registered with. You will receive an email titled **BPCOS OAS Verification Code**. If you do not see it, check your Spam or Junk folder.
2. Find the 6-digit code in the email.

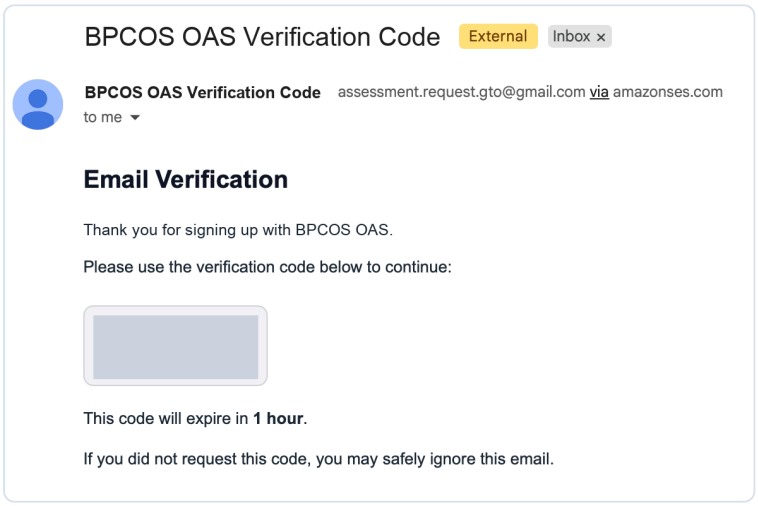


Figure 1.7. The verification email. The code is shown in the box.

The email also says that **the code expires in 1 hour**. If you did not request the code, you can ignore the email.

3. Go back to the verification screen and type the code into the **Verification Code** field.
4. Click **Verify Code**.

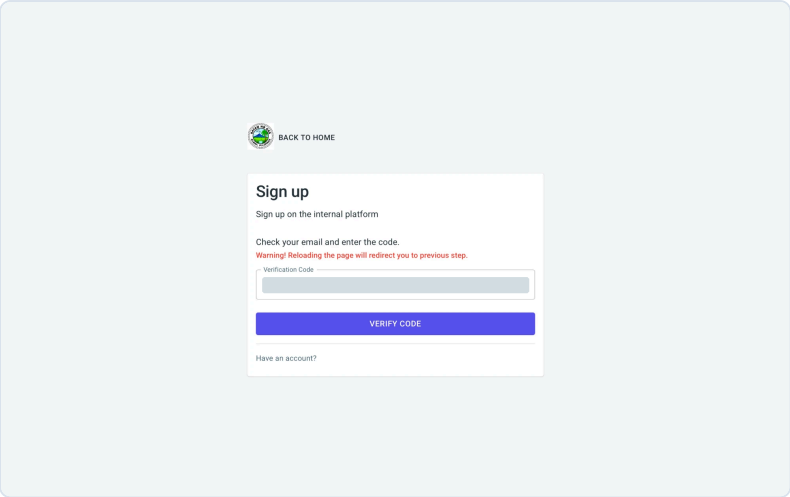


Figure 1.8. Enter the code and click Verify Code.

If the code is correct, you are taken to the Sign in page and a green message appears at the lower left: **Registration completed!** Your account is ready. Enter your email and password to sign in (see Section 1.4).

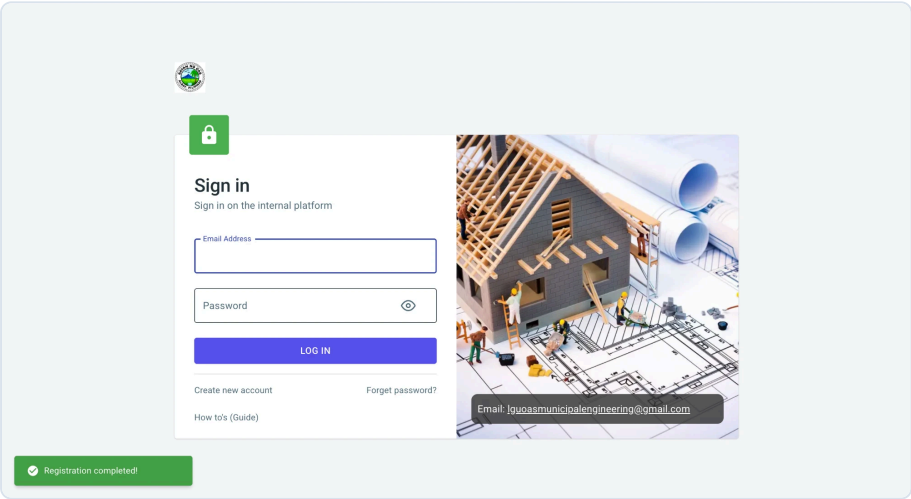


Figure 1.9. The Sign in page with the "Registration completed!" message.

1.6.1 If the code is wrong

If the code you enter is incorrect, an error message appears at the lower left of the screen, as shown below. You stay on the verification screen and can try again.

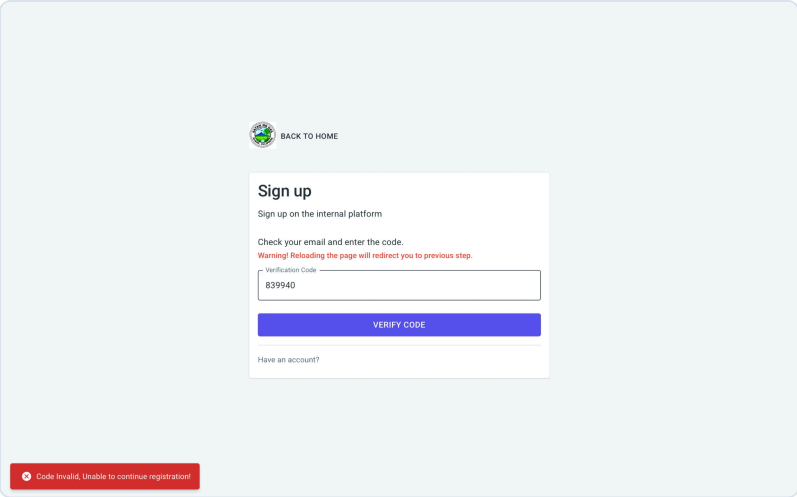


Figure 1.10. A wrong code shows a red message at the lower left.

> **ERROR:** *Code Invalid, Unable to continue registration!* The code you entered does not match. Check the code in the email, retype it carefully and click **Verify Code** again. Do not reload the page.

1.6.2 Other messages you may see while registering

Message	What it means and what to do
Check your email and copy the code! (green)	The code was sent. Open your email and continue with the steps above.
Failed! email is already in use! (red)	An account already exists for this email. Go back to the Sign in page and sign in, or use **Forget password?** if you cannot remember the password.
Code is not sent. Check your internet connection. (red)	The system could not send the email. Check your connection and click **Create account** again.
Must be a valid email / *First name is required* / *Last name is required* / *Email is required* / *Password is required* / *Passwords must match* / *This field must be checked*	A Sign up field is empty or incorrect. The message appears under the field. Correct it and try again.
Registration completed! (green)	Your account is ready. Sign in.

1.7 Forgot your password

If you cannot remember your password, you can set a new one using a link sent to your email.

1.7.1 Step 1. Request a recovery link

1. On the Sign in page, click **Forget password?**

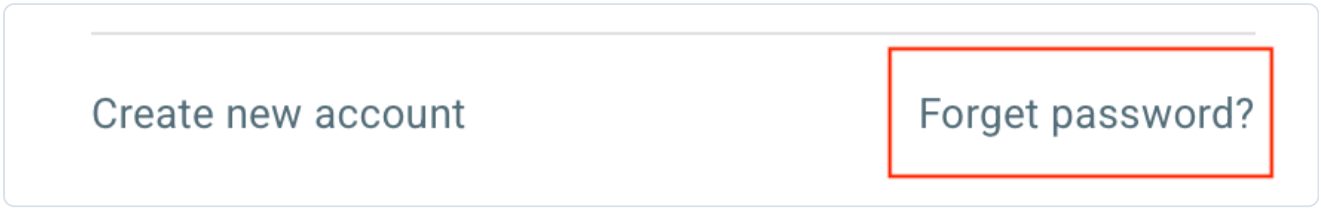


Figure 1.11. Click Forget password? (highlighted) on the Sign in page.

2. On the **Recovery** page, enter the **Email** you registered with.
3. Click **Recover password**.

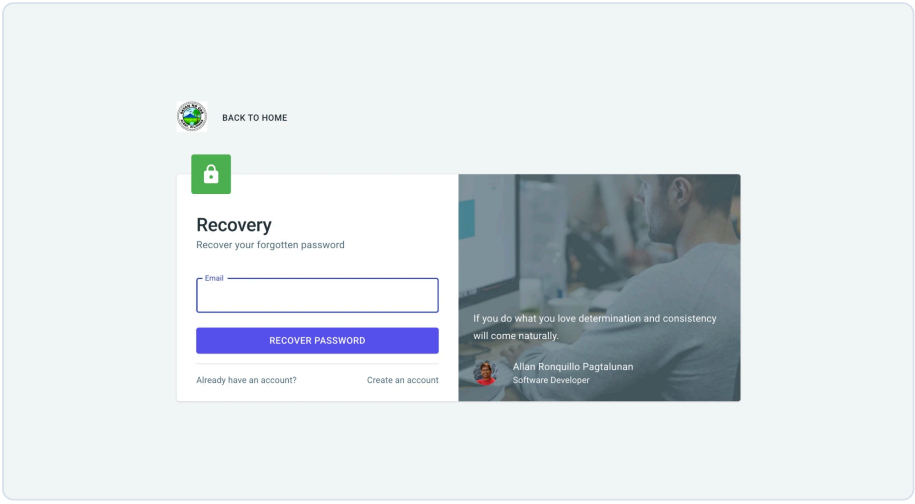


Figure 1.12. The Recovery page.

You are taken back to the Sign in page and a green message appears at the lower left: **Recovery link successfully sent to your email.**

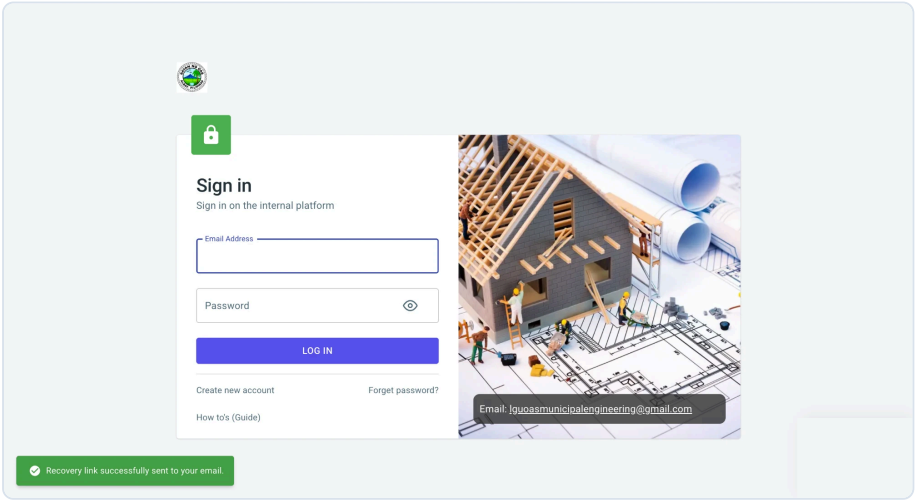


Figure 1.13. The Sign in page with the "Recovery link successfully sent to your email." message.

1.7.2 Step 2. Open the link in your email

Open the email titled **BPCOS Password Reset**. If you do not see it, check your Spam or Junk folder. Click the **Reset Password** button. If the button does not work, copy the link shown in the email and paste it into your browser.

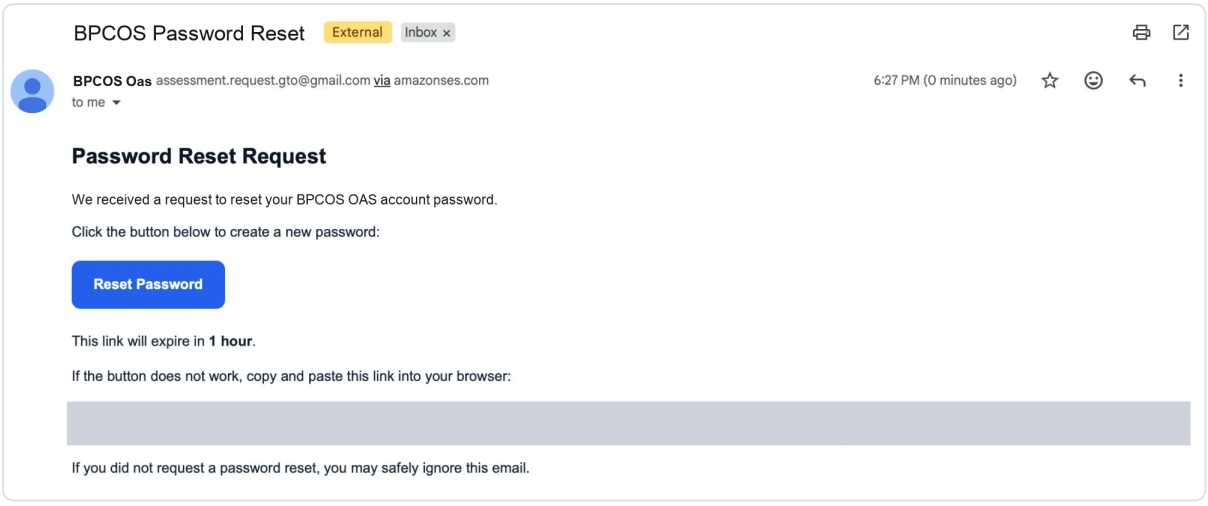


Figure 1.14. The password reset email. The full link is hidden in this figure.

> **WARNING:** the link expires in **1 hour**. If you did not ask for a password reset, ignore the email and your password stays the same. Do not share the link with anyone.

1.7.3 Step 3. Enter a new password

The link opens the **Reset Password** page in your browser.

1. Enter your new **Password** (at least 7 characters).
2. Enter it again in **Confirm Password**.
3. Click **Reset Password**.

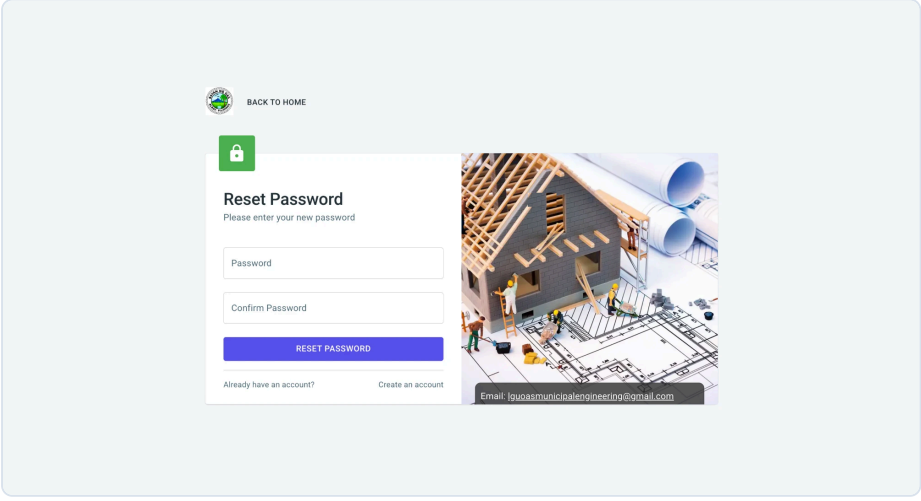


Figure 1.15. The Reset Password page.

After the password is reset, you are returned to the Sign in page. Sign in with your email and the new password.

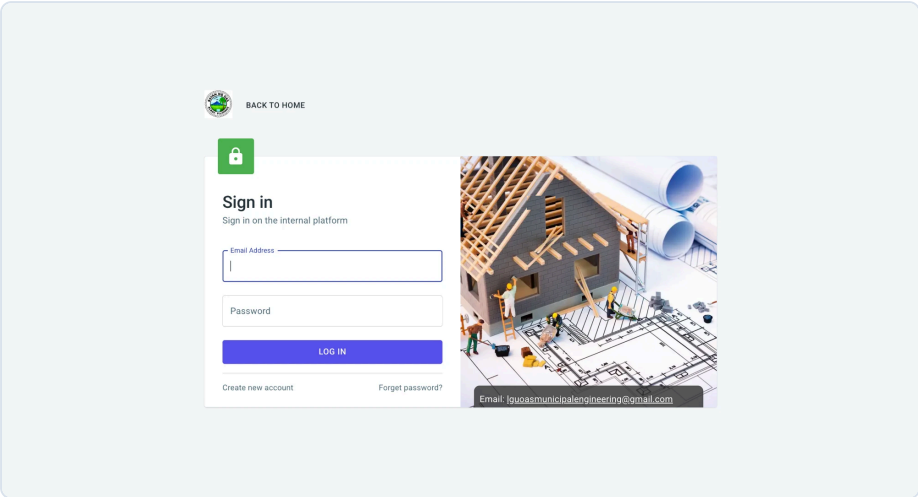


Figure 1.16. You are redirected to the Sign in page after resetting your password.

1.7.4 Messages you may see

Message	What it means and what to do
Email address is required	The Email field on the Recovery page is empty. Enter your email.
Email address not found. (red)	No account exists for that email. Check the spelling, or create an account.
Recovery link successfully sent to your email. (green)	The link was sent. Open your email.
Must be at least 7 characters	The new password is too short. Use 7 or more characters.
Passwords must match	Password and Confirm Password are different. Retype both.
Password Successfully Reset (green)	Your password was changed. Sign in with the new password.

> **ERROR:** if the reset link has expired or is no longer valid, the Reset Password page does not open. Go back to the Sign in page and request a new recovery link (Step 1).

1.8 After you sign in

The applicant Dashboard opens. See Section 2.